

Megapixel? What's that?

The LSST or Large Surveillance Synoptic Telescope aims to take images of the night sky using a massive 3 billion pixel sensor



App of the Year

Instagram won the iPhone 'App of the Year' award thanks for adding two million users each month

tion. Strangely, the Canon SX40 HS performed quite badly and could not resolve the individual pixels very well. The HS20 EXR was the worst of the lot.

Coming to the flash tests, both the Fuji cameras did a good job this time around and performed marginally better than the Sony and the Canon cameras. The two Nikon's also fared well in this test. The grey card test showed the SX40 HS coming into the lead again with far more accurate exposure values as compared to the other cameras. Flash power will have to be manually increased to compensate for the underexposure. The Red Eye tests were of no consequence as none of the cameras showed any hint of red eye in Red Eye Reduction mode.

The low-light test is where the Finepix HS20EXR and the Sony HX100V should have shined, and they did. Both cameras feature special sensors and processing algorithms specifically for improving low-light performance. Even at high ISOs, the Sony HX100V showed very little noise due to its aggressive noise reduction algorithms, this was at the cost of detail and the images were very soft and showed barely any texture. The Finepix HS20 EXR managed to

control noise quite well in the full Auto and EXR modes. The L120 and the S3300 were the worst performers here with extremely noisy and barely usable shots. The cameras did perform reasonably well in P mode at ISO400, exposures were long and required a tripod, but barring the L120, the images were clean. The SX40 HS and P500 took a marginal lead based on sheer image quality.

Image quality at the tele end was very mixed. The Canon SX40 HS showed purple fringing without even zooming in to 100 percent, but the texture and details were great. The two Nikons and the Finepix S3300 showed the least amount of fringing, barely visible at even a 100 percent crop. The Finepix HS20 EXR produced a sharp image but lacked detail while the shots from the Sony HX100V were just about acceptable.

The Finepix HS20EXR performed very well in the video recording tests, especially indoors with very vivid colours. The camera is however, let down by its mechanical zoom ring and insufficient IS. Manipulating the ring resulted in a very jerky zooming experience and the lack of IS showed at the tele end. Sony HX100V had the best per-

formance as far as video went. There was absolutely no shakes while panning and details came out well. Subjects never lost focus even on the smooth zooming. The IS on Canon SX40

Compact Point and Shoot

These cameras are the staple, everyday cameras in this age of digital photography. These cameras have seen a minor



Canon Powershot SX 40HS

HS worked well, image quality was good, focusing was fast and noise suppression was good indoors. The one slight niggle was motor noise being recorded along with the video. The L120 and the S3300 were awful, both cameras showed a lot of noise, couldn't focus and had blown up highlights. The P500 was strictly average in this test and performed decently enough.

Verdict

The verdict is in and the winner is... the Sony DSC HX100V. The camera aced the video tests and came up with the highest test score across all the cameras in the entire comparison. A good camera and packed to the gills with features, this camera is a must buy. Canon's SX40 HS wins our Editor's Pick award. It was actually the best performing camera in this category, but its high price of ₹28,995 pulled it down.

revolution from their earlier "barebones" design. Image manipulation seems to have taken centre-stage here, with the inclusion of diverse shooting and scene modes on every camera, along with options for editing the images on the camera itself.

Features and Design

The Sony DSC-TX55 was possibly, the slimmest camera we received for testing. The Samsung MV800 was also unusual in that it had an articulating LCD that could flip upwards by a full 180 degrees. Both, the Sony DSC-TX55 and Samsung MV800 had touch-screens and the DSC-TX55 even featured an OLED screen. This is a trend we hope to see catching on in cameras soon as an OLED screen has far better contrast and dynamic range than a standard LCD.

What is notable in these cameras is the ridiculous number



Sony DSC-HX100V